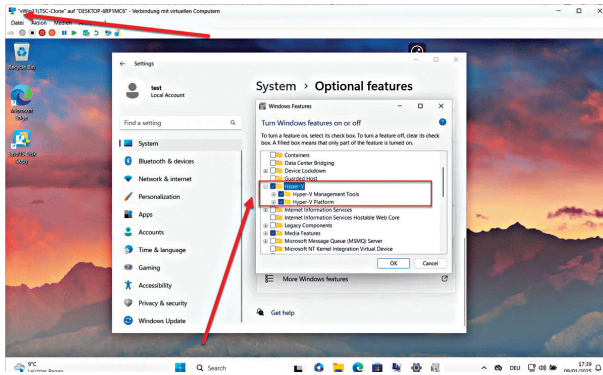




2. Tick Hyper-V
3. OK → Restart

Step-by-step: Create your first VM (basic sanity version)

1. Open Hyper-V Manager
2. Click New → Virtual Machine
3. Choose Generation 2 VM (modern firmware support)
4. Assign memory, CPU, and a virtual disk
5. Mount an ISO to install an OS

If you're installing Windows 11 inside Hyper-V, remember Windows 11 expects security features like Secure Boot/TPM; Microsoft's Hyper-V community guidance highlights that you need a Gen 2 VM for those features.

Fast Track advice: Hyper-V is powerful, but it's also a rabbit hole. If your only goal is "test one suspicious installer," Sandbox is cleaner and faster.

3) Reliability Monitor: the "what changed?" timeline for crashes

Reliability Monitor is the Windows tool you should open before you open Google.

It gives you a stability timeline and logs:

- app crashes
- Windows failures
- driver issues
- update events
- hardware errors

And it helps answer the most important troubleshooting question: When did this start?

Step-by-step: Open Reliability Monitor (two easy ways)

- Press Win + R, type: `perfmon /rel` → Enter
Or:
- Search Start for "reliability" / "View reliability history" (often routes you there).

Microsoft's command reference explicitly lists `perfmon /rel` as starting Reliability Monitor.

How to read it (without overthinking)

- You'll see a graph and a list of events.
- Click a day where things looked bad.
- Look for:
 - "Application failures"
 - "Windows failures"
 - "Hardware errors"
 - "Warnings"

Step-by-step: Use Reliability Monitor to identify the culprit

1. Open Reliability Monitor.
2. Find the first day you noticed the problem.
3. Compare the day before vs that day:
 - Did a driver update install?
 - Did Windows update?
 - Did an app update?
4. Click the specific failure entry and open details.

This is how you stop troubleshooting blind. Reliability Monitor turns "my laptop is cursed" into "this started right after X installed."

4) Event Viewer: the black box recorder for Windows

Event Viewer is where Windows logs what it's doing. If Reliability Monitor is the timeline, Event Viewer is the forensic detail.

Microsoft's own Event Viewer overview explains that "Windows Logs" includes the big three: Application, Security, System—and that "Applications and Services Logs" includes logs from specific components.

Step-by-step: Open Event Viewer

1. Start → type Event Viewer → open
The only logs most people need
Go to:
 - Windows Logs → Application
 - Windows Logs → System
 - Windows Logs → Security (if you're checking logon/audit events)

Step-by-step: Find the real error behind a crash

Let's say an app keeps crashing.

1. Open Event Viewer.
2. Go to Windows Logs → Application.
3. On the right, click Filter Current Log (or use a similar filter option).
4. Filter by Level: Error and Critical.
5. Look for events around the time of the crash.
6. Click an event → read:
 - Source